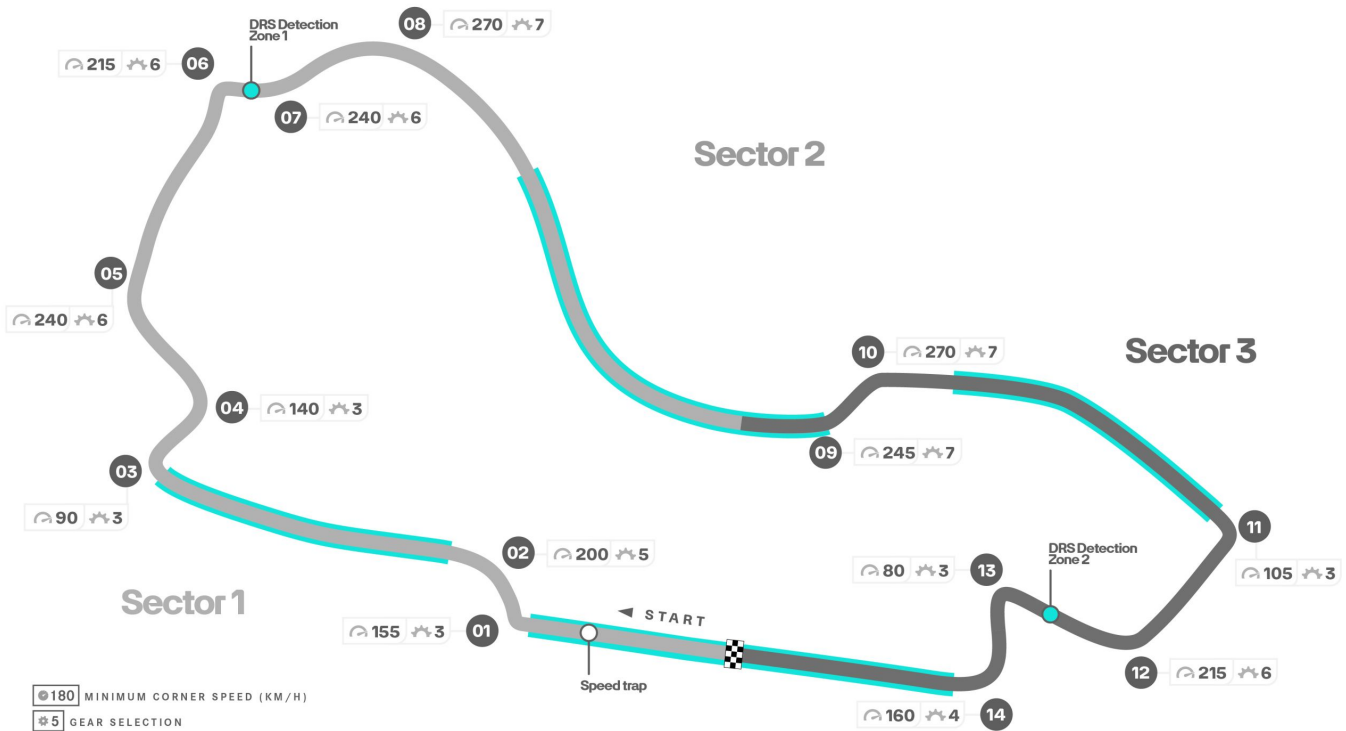


Australian Grand Prix Circuit Guide

Albert Park Circuit | Australian Grand Prix

- First Grand Prix: 1996 = Number of Laps: 58
- Circuit Length: 5.278km
- Race Distance: 306.124 km
- Lap Record: 1:20.235 Sergio Perez (2023)



The fast and flowing Australian Grand Prix circuit follows the roads around the **Albert Park Lake in Melbourne**. The Australian Grand Prix (GP) is considered one of the oldest events in the F1 calendar.

I. General Information and History

- The Australian Grand Prix was held for the first time in **1928** during the pre-Championship era.
- It took time to reserve its spot, but the Australian Grand Prix was held for the first time as a championship event in **1985** and has since become a regular event in the Formula 1 Calendar.
- The event will stay in the championship up until **2035**, according to the current agreement between Formula 1 and race organizers.
- Before shifting to the current location in 1996, the event was held in 23 different venues.
- The Albert Park circuit is only used **once a year**.
- The circuit is categorized as a **street circuit**, utilizing public roads and the track inside the park.
- Compared to other street events, the Australian Grand Prix offers a **smooth and high-speed layout** which better suits modern F1 cars.
- The track surface, typical of a street circuit, needs time to provide the cars with grip as it starts out dusty. Grip improves throughout the weekend, with the ultimate grip peak usually reached in qualifying.

Circuit Dimensions

- The layout of Albert Park is **5.278 km long**.
- Drivers have to go **58 times** around the circuit to cover the race distance.

II. Driver Experience and Circuit Changes

Driver Commentary

- Melbourne is a special place for **Nico Rosberg**, who won there twice in **2014** and his World Championship year, **2016**. He has fond memories of the track.
- **Charles Leclerc** loves Melbourne; it is probably one of his favorite cities of the season.
- **Carlos Sainz** likes the track, but his favorite thing is the city.
- The food in Melbourne is good, the people are so nice, and it is a beautiful country.

New Layout and Track Modifications

The circuit has undergone changes resulting in a new layout.

- **Turn 1:** The curbs on the inside are being moved further in, making the corner **faster**. It is now expected to be taken in at least **fourth gear**.
- **Post-Turn 1 Section:** This part is very difficult, especially in the wet, where it can be very twitchy even though drivers need to be almost flat.
- **Turn 6 (Specific Change):** The inside curb has been moved quite far inward, making this corner much faster. It used to be third gear but is now expected to be **fourth gear** with a lot more speed.
- **The Biggest Change (Middle Sector):** A corner at the back has been **removed**, creating a **long straight**.
 - This section, which was previously flat, flat, flat, is now completely flat out (not DRS).
 - This long straight is a **huge opportunity for overtaking** due to the long slipstream. Overtaking down into the fast corner at the end of the straight will be "pretty hairy" if two cars are side-by-side.
- **Slower Corner Change:** Another corner later in the lap is having its curb moved **outward**, making it slower and giving it a bigger braking zone.
 - This is intended to create another opportunity to overtake.
- **Overall Impact:** The changes were made to make the race more exciting, hoping drivers can follow closer through the fast sections.

III. Detailed Circuit Guide (Previous and Modern Layouts)

2017 Layout Description

The Melbourne Grand Prix circuit is 5.3 km long.

- **Main Straight to Turn 1:** Drivers accelerate down the main straight, scrubbing off speed for Turn 1.
- **Turn 1 (Left-hander):** Carry as much speed as possible into Turn 2.
- **Turn 2 (Left-hander):** Overlooked by grandstands named after Australian Champions **Alan Jones** and **Jack Brabham**.
- **Turn 3 & 4:** Up through the gears, gaining speed towards Turn 3, preparing for a quick change of direction: flicking right then a quick left at Turn 4.

- **Turn 5:** Flat out through the right-handed Turn 5.
- **Turn 6:** Onto a short straight, preparing for another big direction change. A good exit is vital here as the power goes down again.
- **Turn 8:** Sweeping right.
- **Turn 9:** A sharp right that is tricky to negotiate.
- **Turn 10:** Drivers accelerate hard through this picturesque corner, with a **golf course on their left** and the **lake on their right**.
- **Turns 11 & 12 (Chicane):** A seat-of-the-pants high-speed left-right chicane. Drivers are still on the throttle coming down the short straight.
- **Turn 13:** A hard right.
- **Turn 14:** Swiftly followed by 14 and another short straight.
- **Turn 15:** The **90° left of 15** is one of the trickiest corners on the circuit.
- **Final Turn:** Drivers face one final turn before heading back onto the start/finish straight.

Modern Track Guide (F1 24 & F1 25 Setup and Technique)

Note: The setup is a general baseline for hot laps and races and should be tweaked to fit individual style.

Car Setup Priorities

Game Version	Setup Priorities
F1 24	Good balance and stability on the rear, and good front rotation into the corners.
F1 25	Medium speed cornering stability with minimal drag.

Sector 1 (Start/Finish to Turn 6)

Corner/Section	F1 24 Technique	F1 25 Technique
Turn 1 (Entry)	Break right between the 100m and 50m boards , or before the small patch of tarmac on the left. Full application of brakes. Start turning in just past the 50m board.	Watch the 100m board (right behind the black electronic flag sign). Break about one car length past the 100m board. Hard jab at the brakes, holding full pressure for one second, then immediately turn in (good idea to turn in under braking). Downshift to fifth gear .
Turn 1 (Apex/Exit)	Attack the apex; taking a lot of the inside curb makes T2 smoother. Cut the curb completely, leaving only left wheels inside track limits. At the apex, back on power (about 50% throttle).	Take as much inside curb as possible. Aim to steer onto the left exit curb/green tarmac (completely safe). Stomp the gas at mid-corner (safe due to good balance/traction). Ride the green tarmac until the track shifts right.

Corner/Section	F1 24 Technique	F1 25 Technique
Turn 2 (Left-hander)	If T1 line is proper, no track limit issues. Full Throttle before reaching the curb. Use as much curb as possible without going over track limits (completely safe).	Extend to the curb on the right side to gain time, but avoid tapping the wall.
Straight/DRS	Follow through to the right side, use the outside curb. Enable DRS.	Enable DRS at the line. Start naturally moving to the left side.
Turn 4 (Hard Braking)	Sway towards the left side. Break exactly at the 100m board (deeper braking zone than T1). Stay hard on the brakes longer. Start turning in after the left barrier ends. Avoid the inside curb (slanted, not great for stability).	Move towards the left side. Very hard jam of the brakes at the 100m board . Downshift to second gear . Trail braking is important; let off pressure approaching the corner.
Turn 4 (Apex/Exit)	Slowly get back on the power at the apex. Be consistent with throttle to avoid spinning. Sway out to the left side, increasing throttle. Increase to full power at the wheel straight.	Aim to brush right wheels on the inside curb. Increase power as you widen left, pulling back right. Shift to third, aggressively pull back left, aiming to cut close to the curb.
Turn 5 (Quick Right)	Pull towards the right side. Most effective method: 50% lift off the throttle once reaching the right side and turning in. Aim for the inside curb. Back to full throttle at the apex. Watch for track limits (easy to understeer off).	Give the gas a slight lift by about 50% before the left curb. Steadily increase back to full power at the apex. Sway out to the right; avoid reaching track limits until after the curb ends on the right (curb can easily bottom out the car).
Turn 6 (Sweeping Left)	Continue flat out; no need to lift or brake. Sway out to the left on exit to use the left exit curb. Prepare for the next corner.	Stay flat out.

Sector 2 (Turn 7/8 Complex)

Corner/Section	F1 24 Technique	F1 25 Technique
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Corner/Section	F1 24 Technique	F1 25 Technique
Turn 7 (High Speed Entry)	Stick to the right side, staying straight to position left for the corner. Break at about the 70m Mark (couple car lengths beyond the 100m board), but judging the corner is easier. Quick jab to 100% brake pressure; one or two downshifts. Throw the car aggressively into the corner.	Stick to the left side. For this high-speed corner, specific meter boards are distracting; judge based on the wall on the right side and braking power. Nailing entry/exit is extremely important for the long straight ahead.
Turn 7 (Apex/Exit)	Back on the power before the apex. Flat out at the apex. Follow through left, use plenty of the curb (completely flat, safe).	Incredibly quick jab of the brakes to 100% pressure and immediately back on the gas. Downshift to sixth gear (fifth means you braked too much). Cut to the inside wall as much as possible; getting onto the grass is fine. At mid-corner, already at full throttle. Extend to the left on exit; careful not to exceed track limits.
Post T7/T8 Straight	Flat out off the curb, keep a straight line, aim right side, hug the right side. Sway toward the middle as the track twists right, pull back to the right. Enable DRS at the line. Hug the left side as the track moves left, transition right.	Exiting T7/T8, extend back to the right side, pull toward the right wall. Let the car naturally drift left, then pull back right as you hit the DRS zone. Enable DRS at the line. Pull back toward the left for the long left-hander, then transition to the right as the track opens.

Sector 3 (Turns 9 through Final Corner)

Corner/Section	F1 24 Technique	F1 25 Technique
Turn 9/10 (Chicane Entry)	Stick to the right side. Break exactly at the 50m board (not a heavy braking zone). Quick jab to about 50% brake pressure. Immediately turn in. Get back on power while turning in; 60-70% throttle. Take some inside curb.	Stick as close to the right wall as possible. Watch the 50m board, but focus on the apex (meter boards are distracting for high speed). Quick jab of the brakes, downshift to sixth gear . Take as much inside curb as possible, get back to 100% throttle ASAP .
Turn 10 (Exit)	Sway toward the middle, increase to full throttle. Pull back to the left side for a wider line through T10. Stay flat out, turn in right. Use T10 inside curb, avoiding track limits. Follow through to the left exit curb (fully usable). Continue flat out, enable DRS at the line.	Focus on the inside curb on the right. Pull to the left and follow the track just a split second longer than expected. Turn right as the white line ends. Stay full throttle, take inside curb without cutting limits, extend to left exit curb. Get back on the tarmac quickly (F1 25 punishes speed loss on curbs more).

Corner/Section	F1 24 Technique	F1 25 Technique
Turn 11/12 (Next Braking)	Stick to the right, move left. Break pretty much at the 50m board (slightly before is okay due to lock-up risk). Full use of the brakes (100% pressure) . Turn in, hit the apex.	Enable DRS. Shift up to seventh then eighth, moving left. Break at 100m (right after the electronic flag sign). Slam brakes, use trail braking .
Turn 11/12 (Apex/Exit)	Avoid taking the inside curb (possible to bump the car). At the apex, get back on power and extend to the left exit curb.	Avoid the raised orange curb , but cut as close as possible. Mid-corner (second gear), start getting back on the gas and extend to the left side. Get back on the tarmac ASAP.
Turn 13 (Right-hander)	Do not need to break; slight lift of throttle (down to 70%) for a split second. Turn in parallel to the inside curve (aim close to where the curve begins). Stomp on the power at this point and ride out. Naturally places car on the left side; use plenty of the exit curb.	Get up to sixth gear before the corner. Slight lift will do the job (previous games needed brake tap). Give gas a 50% lift , staying in sixth gear. Cut close but do not touch the inside curb (risk of spinning). Immediately back to full power, extend to the left exit curb.
Turn 14 (Sharp Left)	Sway right on the curb, watch for 50m board. Break a bit before the 50m board (easy to lock up). Full use of brakes; need to get slowed down. Rotate the front end smoothly; avoid touching the inside curb . At apex, slowly get back on power (not too much). Extend to the right side (around 50% throttle); do not spike the throttle.	Move back towards the right, watch for the orange barrier. Break about one car length beyond the barrier . Be as close to the right as possible. Easy to lock up: break hard but quickly release pressure as you turn in. Aim to take only the yellow and green curb , avoid the red raised curb. Mid-corner: second gear . Extend to the right side, keeping steering consistent.
Turn 15/Final Turn	Sway back toward the left almost immediately. Start turning into the corner on the left. Do not have to lift, but throttle control is important. Once the inside curb begins, increase to full throttle (feels aggressive but manageable). Power down, extend to the left curb, and enable DRS.	Pull to the left side; full throttle at this point. Start turning back to the right, aiming for the inside curb. Can be taken flat out with the right line (slight lift might be necessary if spinning occurs). Extend to the left side exit curb, use some curb, and enable DRS at the line.

IV. Planning Your Trip to the Australian Grand Prix

Travel and Logistics

Aspect	Detail
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Aspect	Detail
Air Travel (Recommended)	Use Melbourne's main airport in Tullamarine as it is positioned very close to the circuit. Numerous international airlines offer direct flights. Qantas, Virgin Australia, and Jetstar operate local flights.
Air Travel (Not Recommended)	Avalon airport is not a good choice as it is far from the circuit.
Long-Distance Travel	Plenty of local trains are available from other Australian cities (a budget-friendly option). Intercity bus services are available but not recommended due to large distances.
Local Transport	Shuttles, taxis, and Ubers are available within Melbourne City.
Tram (Best Tourist Option)	The tram is the most attractive and easiest option. The service running directly to the circuit is totally free of charge during the Grand Prix weekend. Trams become crowded at the end of each day.
Private Vehicles	Not recommended. There is no dedicated vehicle parking for Albert Park, and strict parking restrictions apply in the vicinity of the circuit area.

Tickets and Viewing Experience

- Albert Park grandstands are **not raised** like those in other modern circuits, which limits the viewing experience.
- It is better to buy tickets for seats in a **higher row** for the best experience.
- All grandstands come with **giant screens** in opposite directions to provide optimum viewing.
- There are **12 Grandstands** to choose from.
- **Best Views:** The **Brabham** and **Jones** grandstands are generally accepted to have the best views.
- **Cheaper Option:** The **Schumacher** grandstand is the best cheaper option.
- **Premium Tickets:** Available for fans wishing to use the top of the Senna and Schumacher grandstands.
- **Children Tickets:** Cost **40%** of the normal ticket fee for each grandstand.
- **General Admission (GA):** Plenty of budget-friendly GA areas are available. Albert Park has built a reputation for having the best GA areas in F1, often offering better views similar to grandstands. There are no reserved seating options in GA areas.

Accommodation and City Exploration

Melbourne is an international city with a mix of global cultures and is a major tourist attraction in the Southern Hemisphere. Plenty of accommodations are available across various budgets and facilities.

Recommended Accommodation Areas

- **Melbourne CBD (City Center):** Has a good collection of hotels. Hotels here are generally a little bit expensive due to high demand. This area offers a **free tram car service**, providing greater accessibility to tourist destinations.
- **South Bank Area:** A good place to stay, offering a great **nightlife experience**. It is positioned next to the Yarra River, offering beautiful sceneries.

- **St Kilda:** The oldest **Beachside suburb** in Melbourne City. It offers a great selection of restaurants and nightlife. Normally, free trams operate to the circuit during the race weekend.
- **South Yara and Docklands:** Also recommended areas with a wide range of hotels and apartments that fit different budget levels.

Sightseeing and Culture

- **Sports History:** Visit the iconic **Melbourne Cricket Ground (MCG)** and the nearby **Australian Open tennis Arena** (both within walking distance of downtown). Step inside the **Australian Sports Museum** within the MCG grounds for insights into Australian sports history.
- **Wine:** Spend a day touring the renowned **Yarra Valley wine region**, home to some of the finest wine brands, enjoying the picturesque landscapes.
- **Wildlife:** Explore diverse marine life at the **Melbourne Aquarium**. See a wide variety of animals at the **Melbourne Zoo** (north of the city center). Try an off-road Safari Adventure at the **Werribee Open Range Zoo** (30 minutes from the city).
- **Day Trip:** Embark on a day trip along the **Great Ocean Road** to see breathtaking coastal scenery and iconic landmarks such as the **Majestic 12 Apostles**.
- **Dining:** Melbourne is a melting pot of different cultures and is world-famous for the quality and choice of its dining experience, offering a wide range of cuisines. This type of dining experience is unique compared to other cities that host Formula 1 events.

Visitor Tips

Topic	Detail
Electrical Devices	Foreign visitors must bring a universal power adapter . Visitors from the United States, Canada, or Japan must also bring a voltage converter .
Voltage	The main supply is 230 volts and 50 Hz (equaling the majority of Asia, Africa, and Europe).
Water	Melbourne's tap water is safer for human consumption and is defined as the world's safest drinking water.
Safety	It is recommended to keep your money and valuables close to yourself during your stay.
Experience	Australia provides the best conditions for an F1 fan to get the full experience of high-speed racing without stressing about outside environmental factors, compared to events in Europe.